

an object representing July 1, 2021, using the `strptime()` method from the `datetime` module. Let's see how `strptime()` works in a terminal session:

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```
>>> from datetime import datetime
>>> first_date = datetime.strptime('2021-07-01', '%Y-%m-%d')
>>> print(first_date)
2021-07-01 00:00:00
```

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We first import the `datetime` class from the `datetime` module. Then we call the method `strptime()` with the string containing the date we want to process as its first argument. The second argument tells Python how the date is formatted. In this example, `'%Y-'` tells Python to look for a four-digit year before the first dash; `'%m-'` indicates a two-digit month before the second dash; and `'%d'` means the last part of the string is the day of the month, from 1 to 31.

The `strptime()` method can take a variety of arguments to determine how to interpret the date. Table 16-1 shows some of these arguments.

**Table 16-1:** Date and Time Formatting Arguments from the `datetime` Module

| Argument | Meaning                                  |
|----------|------------------------------------------|
| %A       | Weekday name, such as Monday             |
| %B       | Month name, such as January              |
| %m       | Month, as a number (01 to 12)            |
| %d       | Day of the month, as a number (01 to 31) |
| %Y       | Four-digit year, such as 2019            |
| %y       | Two-digit year, such as 19               |
| %H       | Hour, in 24-hour format (00 to 23)       |
| %I       | Hour, in 12-hour format (01 to 12)       |
| %p       | AM or PM                                 |
| %M       | Minutes (00 to 59)                       |
| %S       | Seconds (00 to 61)                       |

## Plotting Dates

We can improve our plot by extracting dates for the daily high temperature readings, and using these dates on the *x*-axis:

*sitka\_highs.py*

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```
from pathlib import Path
import csv
from datetime import datetime

import matplotlib.pyplot as plt

path = Path('weather_data/sitka_weather_07-2021_simple.csv')
lines = path.read_text().splitlines()
```